

| Criminal Psychology                                                                                         | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
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| Key Concepts                                                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Different types of crime including: violent; drug related; acquisitive; sexual; and anti-social offences</li> <li>• Criminal behaviour as a social construct including deviation from norms and the role of culture in defining criminal/anti-social behaviour</li> <li>• How crime is measured: official statistics and self-report.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p>Theories/Explanations of why criminal/anti-social behaviour occurs</p> <p>The Social Learning Theory</p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The Social Learning Theory of Criminality: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>◦ identification with role models</li> <li>◦ the role of observation and imitation</li> <li>◦ the process of vicarious reinforcement</li> <li>◦ the role of direct reinforcement and internalisation</li> <li>◦ criticisms of the theory including the nature/nurture debate.</li> </ul> </li> </ul> <p>Social Learning Theory Research Study – Cooper and Mackie (1986): Study into video games and aggression in children.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Eysenck's Criminal Personality Theory                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Eysenck's Criminal Personality Theories (1964 and 1992) and the Biological Basis of Personality (1967)</li> <li>• extraversion; neuroticism; and psychoticism; in relation to criminal behaviour</li> <li>• <u>how the central nervous system relates to cognitions and behaviour, with specific reference to arousal levels and the criminal personality</u></li> <li>• <u>how functions of the brain relate to cognitions and behaviour with specific reference to synapses and dopaminergic neurons and how they interact in an overactive dopamine system in psychoticism</u></li> <li>• <u>the role of dopamine reward systems; the reticular activation system and the cerebral cortex in extroversion</u></li> <li>• <u>the role of the autonomic nervous and the limbic system in neuroticism</u></li> </ul> |